



Best Free IDEs

If you are a developer or wish to become one, try your hands on these top free and Open Source IDEs and see what these can do for you

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An integrated development environment (IDE) is a software program used by developers to code, edit and debug desktop applications, Web applications, Java-based applications and more.

Typically, an IDE consists of a code editor, a compiler, a debugger and a graphical user interface builder. IDEs are designed to maximise programmers' productivity.

This month's EFY Plus DVD contains a collection of top free and Open Source IDEs. If you are a developer or want to be one, try your hands on these IDEs and see what these can do for you.

Eclipse Classic 4.2

Eclipse Classic supports multiple languages. It comes with an extensible plug-in system. Written mostly in Java, it can be used to develop applications in Java and, by means of various plug-ins, other programming languages including Ada, C, C++, COBOL, Haskell, Perl, PHP, Python, R, Ruby (including Ruby on Rails framework), Scala, Clojure, Groovy and Scheme. It is released under Eclipse Public License and is free to use.

The IDE is cross-platform and works well on Linux, Mac OS X, Solaris and MS Windows.

NetBeans IDE 7.1

It has all the tools needed to create professional desktop, enterprise, Web and mobile applications with the Java platform, as well as with C/C++, PHP, JavaScript and Groovy. The latest version included in the EFY Plus DVD includes support for JavaFX 2.0, as well as tools for visual debugging of Swing and JavaFX user interfaces. The IDE is cross-platform and works well on Linux, Mac OS X, Solaris and MS Windows.

Lazarus IDE

The Lazarus IDE is a stable and feature-rich visual programming environment for the FreePascal compiler. It supports creation of self-standing graphical and console applications and runs on Linux, FreeBSD, MacOSX and Windows. It is released under GNU General Public License and is completely free to use.

Orwell Dev-C++

Dev-C++ is useful for programming in C and C++. It includes MinGW GCC 4.6.2 32-bit and provides syntax highlighting for code, header and resource files. It also supports code completion, autocomplete and multiple languages.

The IDE is written in Delphi and is available for Windows. There is an alpha release for Linux too. The IDE is